

Pre-Algebra





About the Course

Students discover algebraic concepts using manipulatives.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Mathematics: Grade 7

Mathematics: Grade 7

For students in elementary school, we recommend RightStart Math (Second Edition), because a) it adheres to Mason's principle that the idea always comes before the algorithm, b) it reflects the very best current research in how children learn mathematics, and c) it offers much-needed support for teachers whose own math instruction may have been lacking. Students in middle school take RightStart Geometry and also add in Pre-Algebra (Hands-On Equations) and Jacobs' Elementary Algebra.

The lessons should be done in the morning and games in the afternoon. Both mental math and games are critical parts of math instruction, so do not skip them. These lessons are paced out to help keep you on track. There are a few catch-up days built in and can be used to finish incomplete work or to review concepts. The general goal should be to complete one lesson per day. It is important that you complete one level per year, even if that means continuing during breaks, as moving slower can affect high school credits later.



Placement & Combining Tips

Prerequisite: RightStart F or mastery of basic arithmetic, fractions, decimals, and percents.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7	Pre-Algebra 2 times/week 30 min	Hands-On Equations Deluxe Home Set The Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems Book

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Mathematics: Grade 7				
Geometry: Grade 7	Pre-Algebra Math Games: Grades 1-8	Geometry: Grade 7 Math Games: Grades 1-8	Pre-Algebra Math Games: Grades 1-8	Geometry: Grade 7



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Mathematics: Grade 7

☐ If you downloaded the RightStart ebook, print out enough copies of each page and put them in a binder for easy access.

☐ Organize math manipulatives for easy access.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Pre-Algebra



Hands-On Equations Deluxe Home Set



The Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems Book



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 10: Math\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Pre-Algebra

How To Teach



Read

The RightStart Math Level G materials are written to the student and may be done independently. However, you may still find it very helpful to work through the lessons to familiarize yourself with the concepts.



Prepare

For Pre-Algebra, it is highly recommended that students be guided by a teacher during these lessons. Teachers may watch the video lessons to learn the concepts and how to teach them to students. If you choose to have your student work independently using the video lessons, you may still find it very helpful to work through the lessons yourself to familiarize yourself with the concepts. Teachers must stay apprised of how students are progressing and be ready to step in and help, since problems can compound quickly. If you are working through the lessons ahead of your student, note the places where you have to stop and think, because those are probably going to be places where students are going to be challenged, as well.



Growth Mindset

Resist the temptation to fall back on just teaching a memorizable procedure when the student struggles with a concept. Growth happens in the struggle. Work on resilience by modeling a growth mindset.



Leave & Return

When your student hits a wall during a lesson, stop and move on to the next subject in your day or take a break. Explain that even when you stop working on a problem, your brain continues to work on it while you do other things, and you don't even know it. Many times, when you come back to the problem the next day, it comes more easily.



Connect

Look for ways to bring math into everyday life and conversation "by the way" - through cooking, gardening, house projects, health, games, etc. Students should discover how math is useful and beautiful, and how it helps us explain and navigate the world.



Term 1

WEEK 1 ☐ 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 1

Balancing the Scale

☐ Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.
Introduction & Level I
Lesson 1 p.3-4

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.
Classwork Sheets
Lesson 1

WEEK 1 ☐ 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 2

Balancing the Scale (continued)

☐ Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.
Introduction & Level I
Lesson 2 p.4

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.
Classwork Sheets
Lesson 2

WEEK 2 ☐ 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 3

"Legal Moves"

☐ Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.
Introduction & Level I
Lesson 3 p.4-6

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.
Classwork Sheets
Lesson 3

WEEK 2 ☐ 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 4

Subtracting from Both Sides

☐ Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.
Introduction & Level I
Lesson 4 p.6-7

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.
Classwork Sheets
Lesson 4



Term 1

WEEK 3 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 5

Original Physical Setup

Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.
Introduction & Level I
Lesson 5 p.7-8

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.
Classwork Sheets
Lesson 5

WEEK 3 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 6

Parentheses

Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.
Introduction & Level I
Lesson 6 p.8

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.
Classwork Sheets
Lesson 6

WEEK 4 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 7

Pictorial Notation

Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.
Introduction & Level I
Lesson 7 p.9-10

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.
Classwork Sheets
Lesson 7

WEEK 4 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 8

Getting Started with Verbal Problems

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.
Sec.1 p.8
Problems 1-10

WEEK 5 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 9

Getting Started with Verbal Problems (continued)

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.



Term 1	
Sec.1 p.9 Problems 11-20	
WEEK 5 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 10 Getting Started with Verbal Problems (continued) Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems → PRACTICE Solve problems and check solutions. Sec.1 p.10 Problems 21-30	
WEEK 6 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 11 Getting Started with Verbal Problems (continued) Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems → PRACTICE Solve problems and check solutions. Sec.1 p.11 Problems 31-39	
WEEK 6 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 12 Number Problems Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems → PRACTICE Solve problems and check solutions. Sec.2 p.25 Problems 1-6	
WEEK 7 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 13 Number Problems (continued) Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems → PRACTICE Solve problems and check solutions. Sec.2 p.26 Problems 7-14	
WEEK 7 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 14 Consecutive Number Problems Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems → PRACTICE Solve problems and check solutions. Sec.3 p.42 Problems 1-11	
WEEK 8 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 15 Age Problems Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems → PRACTICE Solve problems and check solutions. Sec.4 p.57 Problems 1-10	



Term 1

WEEK 8 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 16

Age Problems (continued)

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.
Sec.4 p.57-58
Problems 11-19

WEEK 9 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 17

Coin Problems

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.
Sec.5 p.75-76
Problems 1-11

WEEK 9 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 18

Coin Problems (continued)

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.
Sec.5 p.77-78
Problems 12-26

WEEK 10 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 19

Distance Problems

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.
Sec.6 p.100-101
Problems 1-13

WEEK 10 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 20

Distance Problems (continued)

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.
Sec.6 p.101-103
Problems 14-26

WEEK 11 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 21

Story and Misc. Problems

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.
Sec.7 p.135
Problems 1-8



Term 1

WEEK 11 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 22 Story and Misc. Problems (continued) Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems → PRACTICE Solve problems and check solutions. Sec.7 p.136 Problems 9-15	
WEEK 12 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 23 Exam Week Materials: Hands-On Equations → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Hands-On Equations	
WEEK 12 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 24 Exam Week Materials: Hands-On Equations → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Hands-On Equations	



Term 2

WEEK 1 ☐ 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 25

Introducing the Star

☐ Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.

Level II

Lesson 8 p.1-2

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.

Classwork Sheets

Lesson 8

WEEK 1 ☐ 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 26

Negatives

☐ Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.

Level II

Lesson 9 p.2-3

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.

Classwork Sheets

Lesson 9

WEEK 2 ☐ 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 27

Removing a Pair of Opposites

☐ Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.

Level II

Lesson 10 p.4

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.

Classwork Sheets

Lesson 10

WEEK 2 ☐ 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 28

Balancing by Adding

☐ Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.

Level II

Lesson 11 p.5

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.

Classwork Sheets

Lesson 11



Term 2

WEEK 3 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 29

Adding Pairs of Opposites

Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.

Level II

Lesson 12 p.6

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.

Classwork Sheets

Lesson 12

WEEK 3 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 30

Removing Quantities

Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.

Level II

Lesson 13 p.7

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.

Classwork Sheets

Lesson 13

WEEK 4 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 31

Adding Zero

Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.

Level II

Lesson 14 p.8-9

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.

Classwork Sheets

Lesson 14

WEEK 4 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 32

-x

Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.

Level II

Lesson 15 p.10

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.

Classwork Sheets

Lesson 15



Term 2

WEEK 5 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 33

Pictorial Notation

Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.

Level II

Lesson 16 p.11-13

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.

Classwork Sheets

Lesson 16

WEEK 5 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 34

Number Problems

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.

Sec.2 p.27

Problems 15-19

WEEK 6 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 35

Number Problems (continued)

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.

Sec.2 p.27

Problems 20-24

WEEK 6 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 36

Consecutive Number Problems

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.

Sec.3 p.43

Problems 12-15

WEEK 7 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 37

Consecutive Number Problems (continued)

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.

Sec.3 p.43

Problems 16-19

WEEK 7 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 38

Age Problems

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.



Term 2

Sec.4 p.59
Problems 20-25

WEEK 8 **30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 39**
Coin Problems

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ **PRACTICE**
Solve problems and check solutions.
Sec.5 p.79
Problems 27-31

WEEK 8 **30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 40**
Distance Problems

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ **PRACTICE**
Solve problems and check solutions.
Sec.6 p.104
Problems 27-30

WEEK 9 **30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 41**
Distance Problems (continued)

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ **PRACTICE**
Solve problems and check solutions.
Sec.6 p.104-105
Problems 31-34

WEEK 9 **30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 42**
Story and Misc. Problems

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ **PRACTICE**
Solve problems and check solutions.
Sec.7 p.138
Problems 23-31

WEEK 10 **30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 43**
Story and Misc. Problems (continued)

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ **PRACTICE**
Solve problems and check solutions.
Sec.7 p.139
Problems 32-41

WEEK 10 **30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 44**
Story and Misc. Problems (continued)

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ **PRACTICE**
Solve problems and check solutions.
Sec.7 p.140
Problems 42-50



Term 2

WEEK 11 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 45

Story and Misc. Problems (continued)

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.

Sec.7 p.141

Problems 51-55

WEEK 11 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 46

Catch-Up Day

Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 12 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 47

Exam Week

Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Hands-On Equations

WEEK 12 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 48

Exam Week

Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Hands-On Equations



Term 3

WEEK 1 **30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 49**
Adding and Subtracting Positive and Negative Numbers

Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.
Level III
Lesson 17 p.2-5

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.
Classwork Sheets
Lesson 17

WEEK 1 **30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 50**
Simple Algebraic Equations

Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.
Level III
Lesson 18 p.5-6

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.
Classwork Sheets
Lesson 18

WEEK 2 **30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 51**
Adding Zero

Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.
Level III
Lesson 19 p.7-9

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.
Classwork Sheets
Lesson 19

WEEK 2 **30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 52**
Working with Green and Red Cubes

Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.
Level III
Lesson 20 p.9-10

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.
Classwork Sheets
Lesson 20



Term 3

WEEK 3 ☐ 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 53

Solving More Complex Equations

☐ Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.

Level III

Lesson 21 p.10-12

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.

Classwork Sheets

Lesson 21

WEEK 3 ☐ 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 54

Parentheses

☐ Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.

Level III

Lesson 22 p.12-14

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.

Classwork Sheets

Lesson 22

WEEK 4 ☐ 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 55

Subtracting with Parentheses

☐ Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.

Level III

Lesson 23 p.14-15

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.

Classwork Sheets

Lesson 23

WEEK 4 ☐ 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 56

Solving Equations with $-x$

☐ Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.

Level III

Lesson 24 p.15-16

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.

Classwork Sheets

Lesson 24



Term 3

WEEK 5 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 57

Pictorial Notation

Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.

Level III

Lesson 25 p.16-18

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.

Classwork Sheets

Lesson 25

WEEK 5 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 58

Traditional Written Notation

Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ DEMONSTRATE

Work through examples and discuss.

Level III

Lesson 26 p.19-22

→ PRACTICE

Complete Classwork Sheet and check solutions.

Classwork Sheets

Lesson 26

WEEK 6 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 59

Number Problems

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.

Sec.2 p.28

Problems 25-28

WEEK 6 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 60

Number Problems (continued)

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.

Sec.2 p.28

Problems 29-32

WEEK 7 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 61

Consecutive Number Problems

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.

Sec.3 p.44

Problems 20-24



Term 3

WEEK 7 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 62

Consecutive Number Problems (continued)

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.
Sec.3 p.44
Problems 25-29

WEEK 8 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 63

Age Problems

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.
Sec.4 p.60
Problems 26-31

WEEK 8 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 64

Age Problems (continued)

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.
Sec.4 p.60
Problems 32-36

WEEK 9 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 65

Coin Problems

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.
Sec.5 p.80
Problems 32-36

WEEK 9 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 66

Coin Problems (continued)

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.
Sec.5 p.80-81
Problems 37-41

WEEK 10 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 67

Coin Problems (continued)

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.
Sec.5 p.81
Problems 42-45



Term 3

WEEK 10 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 68

Distance Problems

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.
Sec.6 p.106
Problems 35-39

WEEK 11 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 69

Distance Problems (continued)

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.
Sec.6 p.106-107
Problems 40-44

WEEK 11 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 70

Story and Misc. Problems

Materials: Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems

→ PRACTICE

Solve problems and check solutions.
Sec.7 p.142
Problems 56-62

WEEK 12 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 71

Exam Week

Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Hands-On Equations

WEEK 12 30m Pre-Algebra - Lesson 72

Exam Week

Materials: Hands-On Equations

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Hands-On Equations

Pre-Algebra

Examination

- Term 1** · Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems Book: p.137 (#16-22)
- Term 2** · Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems Book: p.176-177 (#1-10)
- Term 3** · Hands-On Equations Verbal Problems Book: p.143 (#63-69)